

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A8: Free Composition and Independent Research

Define an evaluable project, maintain a source-and-idiom ledger, and complete a supported first revised Latin draft without overstating portfolio maturity

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	EL-A7 and a passing guided composition with visible revision
Next	EL-GATE-IV, Advanced Reading and Composition Assessment Sequence (A-A and delayed A-B); no graduation claim before passage

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A8. Free composition and independent research

Free composition is not support-free composition. Advanced writers still use grammars, dictionaries, corpora, models, revision, and informed readers. What becomes free is the choice and organization of content.

Free composition is composition in which the writer chooses and organizes the propositions and principal structures rather than completing a supplied frame. It remains accountable to evidence and revision. A **corpus** is a defined body of texts searched or compared as evidence for usage; it is not automatically representative merely because it is large. An **attested construction** is one actually documented in a relevant source, though one occurrence alone may not prove that it suits every context.

On completing this unit, you can:

- define an evaluable original ecclesiastical prose project;
- maintain a source and idiom ledger;
- produce and revise one supported 150–250-word Latin draft; and
- distinguish that module milestone from a mature portfolio or final claim of independence.

1.1 From proposal to supported draft

A **portfolio** is a curated body of work selected to demonstrate range, development, and final competence; it includes drafts and rationale, not only clean products. A **source ledger** records borrowed wording and its exact location. An **idiom ledger** records a construction, its contextual sense, and a relevant attestation so that evidence can be reused without severing it from context.

This module produces one bounded portfolio artifact, not the completed portfolio. Define its audience, register, propositions, evidence, and success criterion before drafting 150–250 words. Preserve the proposition plan, first draft, correction layer, source and idiom ledger, revised draft, rubric, and unresolved list as one auditable record.

For every borrowed phrase, record the exact source. For every unusual construction, record a grammar section or credible parallel. This is scholarly hygiene, not an admission that the writing is not free. Revise in three deliberate passes: proposition and clause skeleton, concord and government, then lexicon, cohesion, and register.

1.2 Planning a later independent reading dossier

A **dossier** is an organized packet of evidence and analysis directed to one inquiry. Unlike a portfolio, which demonstrates a writer's development across pieces, a reading dossier assembles the textual, grammatical, allusive, rhetorical, and register evidence needed to explain one formulary.

Do not choose or open the dossier's Mass during this module. Prepare a blank plan for later use with Worksheet IV.31 or EL-GATE-IV. It should reserve places to:

- record the blind selection method and prior-exposure declaration;
- preserve the no-aid first pass and every later lookup;

- map the most difficult prayer and connected reading;
- test allusion, rhetoric, and register claims from exact Latin evidence;
- summarize the formulary without a line-by-line translation; and
- list residual uncertainties and proposed ways to resolve them.

The empty plan is preparation, not evidence that the later unfamiliar reading has already been completed.

1.3 Local module boundary

Fluency does not mean instant recall of every rare lemma. It means that forms and ordinary syntax are transparent enough for attention to rest on argument, image, source, and style. A dictionary lookup should add a word, not assemble the sentence on the learner's behalf.

Here **fluency** means reliable, increasingly automatic access to ordinary forms, constructions, and discourse relations during reading and writing. It is compatible with deliberate analysis of a difficult period and consultation for a rare word. **Independence** means that those aids refine or verify a proposed reading rather than supply the grammatical structure the learner cannot yet see.

Those are course-level standards, not claims conferred by this packet. The local milestone is one bounded proposal, its source and idiom ledger, and one supported first revision. A mature portfolio, an unfamiliar-Mass dossier, a delayed revision, and a defense remain for EL-GATE-IV.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 From proposal to supported draft — transfer practice

Connection. A bounded artifact still needs an evidence trail that distinguishes planning, borrowing, correction, and revision.

Transfer task. Prepare an assembly checklist in this order: proposal, proposition plan, first draft, correction layer, source and idiom ledger, revised draft, rubric, and unresolved list. Use it while completing Worksheets IV.29 and IV.30 and the later draft.

Retrieval check. Identify which artifacts prove that a polished sentence was revised rather than copied.

1.2 Planning a later independent reading dossier — transfer practice

Connection. Reading evidence must remain independent from the composition's chosen source material.

Transfer task. Prepare the empty Worksheet IV.31 dossier plan now: blind heading selection, exposure declaration, cold map, lookup ledger, direct summary, difficult-form notes, and residual uncertainties. Do not select or read its Mass in this module.

Retrieval check. State why a text mined for the composition cannot serve as blind reading evidence.

1.3 Local module boundary — transfer practice

Connection. A local milestone must name the evidence actually produced without inflating it into course completion.

Transfer task. Draft a one-sentence claim limited to the proposal, ledger, and supported first revision, then list the later evidence reserved to EL-GATE-IV.

Retrieval check. Name the three local deliverables and two course-level claims this packet cannot establish.

1.4 Worked proposal-to-draft process — transfer practice

Connection. A strong free project narrows choices before prose expands.

Transfer task. Create a project-composed model packet: one-sentence aim, six propositions, declared register, three checked construction models, 150–250-word draft, and three-pass change log.

Retrieval check. For each model, distinguish borrowed phrase from abstract construction.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A8 worksheet family: independent work

Worksheet IV.29 — Composition proposal

Worksheet ID: IV.29

Focus: Define a free project that can be evaluated.

Use: Complete before drafting the portfolio piece.

1. State audience, register, genre, and length.

-
2. List four propositions the piece must communicate.

-
3. Name two authentic prose models and what each contributes.

-
4. Set a limit on borrowed strings.

-
5. Draft a structural outline in Latin headings and clause frames.
-

Worksheet IV.30 — Source and idiom ledger

Worksheet ID: IV.30

Focus: Make advanced support visible.

Use: Keep beside every free draft.

1. Record five borrowed or closely imitated phrases with exact sources.

-
2. Record five disputed word choices.

-
3. Record three complex syntactic choices.

-
4. When does a source ledger reveal patchwriting?

-
5. How should patchwriting be revised?
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

1.1 Advanced composition rubric

Score each category from 0 to 4. A piece is ready for the portfolio at 3 or 4 in every category; a high total cannot conceal a structural failure.

A **rubric** is a scoring instrument that defines separate dimensions of performance and describes evidence at each level. Here **morphology** scores the forms produced; **syntax** scores their dependencies; **lexicon** scores contextual word choice; **cohesion** scores relations across clauses and sentences; **register** scores consistency with the chosen language model; **rhetoric** scores arrangement in service of thought; **documentation** scores traceability of evidence; and **revision** scores principled improvement across drafts. The categories overlap in actual prose, but each diagnoses a different kind of strength or failure.

Category	4: independent	3: sound	2 or below: revise
Morphology	accurate throughout; any rare form defensible	isolated slip, no repeated pattern	repeated or meaning-changing form errors
Syntax	relations clear, varied, idiomatic, controlled	sound core with limited awkwardness	English calques, broken government/sequence, or ambiguous spine
Lexicon	precise contextual senses and attested constructions	generally apt with minor repetition	first-gloss substitutions or anachronistic sense
Cohesion	explicit logical movement and stable reference	readable sequence with occasional rough join	sentence pile without controlled relation
Register	consistent chosen ecclesiastical model	mostly consistent	accidental mixture or unsupported imitation
Rhetoric	arrangement serves thought without display	some effective balance/repetition	labels or ornament disconnected from meaning
Documentation	all borrowed language and disputed choices traceable	small citation gaps	patchwriting or unverifiable claims
Revision	drafts show principled structural and stylistic decisions	errors corrected with explanation	clean copy only or unexplained replacement

Advance when: Submit a bounded proposal, complete source/idiom ledger, and first revised 150–250-word Latin draft; score the draft in all eight advanced-rubric categories and reach at least 3 in every row, while marking unresolved choices and making no final-independence claim.

Course boundary. The two-session deliverable is a proposal and supported first revised draft. A mature portfolio, unfamiliar-Mass dossier, delayed revision, and defense are tested by EL-GATE-IV; Worksheets IV.31 and IV.32 remain optional rehearsal rather than hidden required pages.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-GATE-IV, Advanced Reading and Composition Assessment Sequence (A-A and delayed A-B); no graduation claim before passage.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.31 and IV.32 remain optional rehearsal for the independent reading dossier and final portfolio audit.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

From proposal to supported draft — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The marked first draft and correction layer show revision; the source and idiom ledger distinguishes borrowed wording and modeled construction. A clean final alone cannot prove process.

Planning a later independent reading dossier — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The design keeps the dossier's selection and cold record separate from composition research. Prior mining changes exposure and must be disclosed; it may support study but not blind transfer.

Local module boundary — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The local deliverables are the bounded proposal, source and idiom ledger, and supported first revision. A mature portfolio, unfamiliar-formulary dossier, delayed retention, final audit, and defense remain outstanding; the packet establishes neither independence nor graduation.

Worked proposal-to-draft process — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model labels all new Latin project-composed, cites every borrowed phrase, describes abstract syntax without claiming ownership of wording, and records at least one substantive revision in skeleton, concord, and idiom.

CHAPTER 2

A8 worksheet family: independent work

Solution IV.29 — Composition proposal

Worksheet ID: IV.29

Focus: Define a free project that can be evaluated.

Use: Complete before drafting the portfolio piece.

1. State audience, register, genre, and length.

Answer / model: Model: “An advanced Latin reader; Vulgate-influenced expository prose; meditation; 180–220 words.” Specific answers vary.

2. List four propositions the piece must communicate.

Answer / model: Answers vary; each should be content, not an English sentence to translate.

3. Name two authentic prose models and what each contributes.

Answer / model: Provide exact citations and a feature such as relative architecture, connective logic, or vocabulary—not merely an author name.

4. Set a limit on borrowed strings.

Answer / model: Model policy: quote only deliberately and cite; otherwise imitate construction with new vocabulary; maintain a phrase ledger.

5. Draft a structural outline in Latin headings and clause frames.

Answer / model: A sound outline assigns a grammatical architecture to each proposition and identifies likely transitions.

Solution IV.30 — Source and idiom ledger

Worksheet ID: IV.30

Focus: Make advanced support visible.

Use: Keep beside every free draft.

1. Record five borrowed or closely imitated phrases with exact sources.

Answer / model: For each: source, exact borrowed words, grammatical adaptation, and purpose in the new text.

2. Record five disputed word choices.

Answer / model: For each: lemma, sense, construction, dictionary/corpus evidence, rejected alternative.

3. Record three complex syntactic choices.

Answer / model: For each: clause type, sequence/government, model or grammar reference, and final verification.

4. When does a source ledger reveal patchwriting?

Answer / model: When borrowed strings carry the prose without an independently planned syntax or argument, or when citations are omitted and transitions are uncontrolled.

5. How should patchwriting be revised?

Answer / model: Return to propositions, rebuild the sentence architecture independently, retain only deliberate quotation, and document genuine imitation.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A8, *Free Composition and Independent Research*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The packet deliberately stops at proposal and supported first revision. The separate EL-GATE-IV companion supplies the required independent dossier and final-audit evidence.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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